Musse Hidru

Gameplay Programmer & Designer **Chestermere, AB, Canada**
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Skills: Gameplay Systems Design, Rapid Prototyping, High-level and Reverse Game Design Documentation, Code Architecture, Unity C#, Physics-Based Interactions, UI/UX Design & Implementation, Version Control (Git), Agile Workflow, Beginner-level Unreal Blueprints

Software: Unity, Unreal Engine, Pico-8, JetBrains Rider, Visual Studio, Microsoft Office Suite, Notion, Slack, Trello, ClickUp, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Draw.io, GitHub, Bitbucket, Git Kraken, Fork

Education

Advanced Game Development Diploma | Bow Valley College, Calgary **Jan 2023 – Dec 2024**

- **Game Design:** Learned to design gameplay systems, loops, and enemy encounters with a focus on player experience, studying how UX and player psychology influence emergent gameplay
- **Game Development Pipeline:** Learned how to rapid prototype, use version control, and Agile workflow, with an understanding of tech, art, design, and production pipelines to support cross-disciplinary collaboration
- **Game Engines:** Hands-on experience with Unity and Unreal, using both engines to create mechanics, design gameplay systems, and form industry-standard workflows

Projects

Flashes of Madness | Unity **Sep 2024 – Apr 2025**

A first-person horror game where players use a flashlight and solve puzzles to progress through tense, atmospheric environments. Developed over 8 months, released demo in Dec 2024 on itch.io

- **Gameplay Design:** Designed gameplay loops that guided players through horror-driven encounters, balancing pacing and mechanics to maintain tension and immersion
- **Gameplay Programming:** Implemented flashlight mechanics, puzzle systems, modular scene loading, and a save system

Bubble Buddy | Unity **Jan 2025**

A game inspired by the themes "Bubble" and "You Are the Weapon," for Pirate Software Jam 16 and Global Game Jam you play as a bubble who is trying to survive a wave of fish. Developed in 2 weeks as a prototype on itch.io

- **Gameplay Design:** Designed gameplay that uses bubbles as both offense and health, creating a risk-reward dynamic
- **Gameplay Programming:** Programmed player controls, enemies, coded animations, and leaderboard functionality

Wavy Davy | Unity **Jul 2024 – Aug 2024**

A surfing competition game where players build speed, avoid obstacles, and perform tricks to maximize their score. Developed over 1 month, released on itch.io

- **Gameplay Programming**: Implemented a modular arrow combo system for trick sequences, with multi-track music to play during phases, and added a leaderboard to incentivize competition

Work Experience

Junior Game Developer | Double Rex Studios Inc. **Apr 2025 – Present**

- Develop gameplay systems and UI implementation for an unannounced title, integrated into an existing production codebase
- Diagnose and fix bugs across gameplay and UI systems
- Propose and implement features that improve user experience

Mitacs Project Specialist | Bow Valley College **Apr 2026 – Present**

- Design and program game projects
- Debug and extend existing game systems

Lab Instructor | Bow Valley College **May 2024 – Mar 2026**

- Assisted students with understanding game architecture and programming concepts
- Helped troubleshoot and fix bugs in student projects
- Guided students in improving game feel and refining game concepts

Lead Game Programmer, Game Designer | Kraken Hunters **Mar 2024 – Apr 2025**

- Worked collaboratively across design, art, and testing within a small indie team
- Designed and developed game systems and mechanics for Horror, Couch Co-op, RPG, Roguelike, and VR titles
- Participated in Indie Ignition Program and Competed against other local game companies in Calgary
- Contributed to multiple released projects on itch.io, including *Flashes of Madness* and more

Co-Founder, Game Designer, Game Programmer | Knite Studios n.k.a (Smooth Brain) **Sep 2023 – Mar 2024**

- Designed and developed game mechanics, and UI/UX systems for small scale indie games
- Designed and prototyped a Board Game that could be played with 2 – 5 players
- Participated in 3-day game jams, releasing prototypes such as *Stick it* and *Dango*